

Third-Party Evaluation of Plantation Works in Gujarat (2019–2025)

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Quality Council of India (QCI) is an autonomous organisation established in 1997, through joint initiative of the Government of India and the Indian industry, pursuant to resolution of the Indian Cabinet in 1996. It is registered as a Society under the Societies Registration Act, 1860 with the mandate to establish and operate the national accreditation system in India and promote quality in all aspects of life, industry, environment, and governance. It is a self-sustaining independent organisation with complete financial, administrative, and functional autonomy. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India is the nodal point in the government for QCI and all matters concerning quality.

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Introduction

1. Background

- 1.1. Gujarat is a forest-deficient state with only about 11% of its geographical area classified as forest, significantly lower than the national average. Despite this, the state exhibits unique ecological features such as the saline deserts of the Rann, extensive grasslands, and the country's longest coastline, contributing to a rich variety of ecosystems.
- 1.2. The state is home to globally significant fauna, including the last remaining populations of Asiatic lions in Gir and wild asses in the Little Rann of Kachchh. Gujarat supports 14% of the country's fish species, 18% reptiles, 37% avifauna, and 25% of mammal species diversity – making it a vital region for wildlife conservation.
- 1.3. Gujarat has a total recorded forest area (RFA) of 21,647 sq. km, constituting about 11.03% of its total area. This includes 66.39% Reserved Forests, 13.33% Protected Forests, and 20.28% Unclassed Forests, distributed across various agro-climatic and ecological zones.
- 1.4. According to Champion & Seth's classification, Gujarat's forests fall into four major types: Tropical Moist Deciduous, Littoral and Swamp, Tropical Dry Deciduous, and Northern Tropical Thorn Forests. These span a wide range of ecosystems from coastal mangroves to inland dry forests, highlighting the complexity of forest governance in the state.

2. Context

- 2.1. Social Forestry and Agroforestry Programs: Gujarat's Forest Department has pioneered the Social Forestry Programme, focusing on tree plantations on non-forest lands such as wastelands, Panchayat lands, roadsides, canals, and institutional premises to increase green cover and improve ecological balance. Farmer-centric agroforestry plantations have covered over 45,939 hectares during 2023–25, supported by training camps and community participation.
- 2.2. Massive Plantation Drives and Innovative Schemes: The state has planted over 174 million saplings as part of continuous afforestation efforts. New initiatives in 2023-24 include Harit Van Path (70 hectares), Panchratna Gram Vatika (covering 1,000 villages), plantations around Amrit Sarovars, and development of Van Kutirs, Panchvati Centres, and sacred groves (Pavitra Upvan), enhancing biodiversity and community engagement.
- 2.3. Community Involvement and Environmental Awareness: The Forest Department organizes Kisan Shibirs (farmer camps), medical camps, and awareness programs to promote tree planting and sustainable forest management. These efforts aim to integrate rural and urban communities in forestry activities, enhancing livelihoods and environmental conservation.

Quality Council of India (QCI)

3. Introduction to QCI

- 3.1. The Quality Council of India (QCI) has been set up as a non-profit autonomous society registered under the Societies Registration Act XXI of 1860 to establish an accreditation structure in the country and to spread quality movement in India by undertaking a National Quality Campaign.

- 3.2. QCI was established as the National body for Accreditation on recommendations of the Expert Mission of the EU after consultations between the Inter-Ministerial Task Force, Committee of Secretaries, and Group of Ministers and finally a Cabinet decision in 1996.
- 3.3. The Council was made an autonomous non-profit organisation through seed funding initially by the Government of India and the Indian Industry represented by the three premier industry associations: Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM), Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) and Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI).
- 3.4. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry is the nodal point for all matters connected with Quality and QCI.
- 3.5. QCI has established Constituent Boards, Divisions, and Cells catering to various aspects of quality. Its Boards are full members of international systems of accreditation and have multilateral mutual recognition arrangements (MRAs/MLAs) that allow for international equivalence and recognition of conformity assessment outcomes.



Figure 1: QCI Organisational Structure

3.6. Constituent Boards

- 3.6.1. **National Accreditation Board for Testing & Calibration Laboratories (NABL):** NABL accredits testing, calibration, and medical labs, as well as proficiency testing providers and reference material producers, based on international standards. NABL is a member of ILAC and APAC.
- 3.6.2. **National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies (NABCB):** NABCB accredits Certification, Inspection, and Validation/Verification Bodies based on international standards and is a full member of IAF, ILAC, and APAC.
- 3.6.3. **National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers (NABH):** NABH accredits hospitals and healthcare organisations, with internationally recognized accreditations.
- 3.6.4. **National Accreditation Board for Education & Training (NABET):** NABET accredits education, training, and skill development organisations to national and international standards, enhancing quality and credibility.

- 3.6.5. **National Board for Quality Promotion (NBQP):** NBQP promotes quality and excellence in India by setting standards, providing certifications, and conducting audits to enhance competitiveness and customer satisfaction.
- 3.6.6. **Special Projects Group (Cells and Divisions)**
 - 3.6.6.1. **Project Planning and Implementation Division (PPID):** The Project Planning and Implementation Division (PPID), under the Special Project Group of QCI, is responsible for project initiation, development, planning, and execution, especially for the Government.
 - 3.6.6.2. **Project Analysis and Documentation Division (PADD):** The Project Analysis and Documentation (PAD) Division of the QCI handles projects that aim towards the design, development, and implementation of voluntary conformity assessment frameworks for governmental, inter-governmental, regional, and global organizations. The Division drives initiatives that have national, regional, and global relevance.
 - 3.6.6.3. **National Division for Industry Excellence (NDIE):** The National Division for Industry Excellence looks after the implementation of the ZED scheme and associated activities. The scheme is an integrated and holistic certification system that will account for quality, productivity, energy efficiency, and pollution mitigation, financial status, human resources, and technological depth, including design and IPR in both products and processes.
 - 3.6.6.4. **Strategy & Policy Division (SPD):** Specialized Unit complementing and augmenting capacity of the government in policy making, especially in the field of quality. It provides services in the following domains: (a) quality evaluation of goods, services, programmes, processes, and organisations, (b) strategic research and advisory in regulation, policy, quality, technology, and population scale transformations, and (c) knowledge development and analysis for emerging/futures policies.

4. Key projects

- 4.1. In 25 years, the Quality Council of India (QCI) has improved quality of life through initiatives in green development, inclusive growth, digital economy, public infrastructure, and technology. It involves stakeholders to uphold quality standards and enhance citizens' well-being.
- 4.2. As the National Accreditation body of the country, it has been ranked 5th in the world in the recent Global Quality Infrastructure Index (GQII) 2021. In the past 10 years, QCI Professionals have engaged with 90+ ministries and departments of the Union and State Governments in executing 400+ projects across multivariate spheres.
- 4.3. The various Third-Party Evaluation of projects undertaken by QCI include the following:
 - 4.3.1. Third-Party Evaluation of Scheme 1 & 2 of National Horticulture Board (NHB)
 - 4.3.2. Third-Party Assessment of FCI warehouses
 - 4.3.3. Third-Party Re-Assessment of FCI owned warehouses
 - 4.3.4. Third-Party Assessment of Procurement Centers in KMS 2021-22 & RMS 2011-23
 - 4.3.5. Third-Party Evaluation of Animal Husbandry & Infrastructure Development Fund (AHIDF) Scheme

- 4.3.6. National Gopal Ratna Award 2022, 2023, 2024
- 4.3.7. Third Party Sampling & Analysis of Coal (Ongoing)
- 4.3.8. GeM vendor assessment
- 4.3.9. Quality Intervention to create a Quality Ecosystem for Khadi

and more than 100 further projects are being awarded to QCI on nomination basis. Work Order will be provided as per requirement.

Gujarat Forest Department

5. About Gujarat Forest Department

The Gujarat Forest Department, functioning under the Forest and Environment Department, Government of Gujarat, plays a pivotal role in conserving, restoring, and expanding the state's forest resources. As Gujarat features a diverse landscape comprising saline deserts, dry deciduous forests, coastal belts, grasslands, and hilly terrain, the department has developed a range of plantation models tailored to suit these varying agro-ecological zones. With forest cover accounting for only 11–12% of the total geographical area—below the national average—plantation activities are among the department's most critical interventions for enhancing green cover and ecological resilience.

The department implements these activities through a combination of departmental efforts, community participation, decentralized models, and externally funded schemes, with a particular focus on ecological restoration, biodiversity enhancement, sustainable livelihoods, and climate change mitigation. Below is an overview of the key models and components that form the core of plantation initiatives under the Gujarat Forest Department:

- 5.1. **Plantation Models and Activities:** The Gujarat Forest Department undertakes a wide range of plantation models to suit different site conditions, stakeholder needs, and ecological functions. These include:
 - b. **Departmental Plantations:** Carried out directly by the department on government lands, degraded forest areas, and reserve forests, these plantations follow scientific forestry practices and aim to improve forest density, biodiversity, and ecosystem services.
 - c. **Farm-based and Scattered Plantations:** Under social forestry and agroforestry programs, the department promotes tree plantations by farmers on private agricultural lands, along field bunds, canal banks, and community spaces. Models include:
 - Farm Forestry (FF) and Forest Land (FL) plantations,
 - Fruit sapling plantations for nutritional and income benefits,
 - Environmental plantations for urban and peri-urban areas,
 - Agroforestry models integrating trees with crops and livestock.

These efforts contribute to increasing tree cover outside forests (TOF), support sustainable farming systems, and enhance climate resilience at the farm level.

- d. **Direct Seed Sowing (DSS) Plantations:** DSS is a cost-effective plantation method used by the department in suitable areas, involving the direct broadcasting or dibbling of seeds on prepared land. It is widely applied in large, inaccessible, or low-resource regions where nursery-raised transplantation is not feasible.

5.2. **Age-Wise Management of Plantations:** The Gujarat Forest Department manages its plantations based on age cohorts to ensure proper silvicultural care and monitoring at every stage. The department actively maintains the following age-based plantation groups:

- Year Old Plantations: Requiring intensive care, mortality replacement, and weed control.
- 2 Year to 5-Year-Old Plantations: Entering the establishment phase with ongoing protection, pruning, thinning, and soil enrichment.
- 6–10-Year-Old Plantations: Particularly under CAMPA, these plantations require selective harvesting, monitoring, and interventions for regeneration and sustainability.

This structured management approach helps in maximizing survival, growth, and long-term forest productivity.

5.3. **CAMPA Plantations:** The department implements extensive plantation activities under the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority (CAMPA). CAMPA plantations are financed through funds collected from user agencies for diverting forest land to non-forest purposes. These plantations focus on:

- Reforestation of degraded forest lands,
- Use of native species and biodiversity-friendly practices,
- Long-term monitoring and third-party evaluations to ensure transparency and ecological impact.

CAMPA plantations are currently among the largest afforestation efforts in the state, with activities monitored annually for survival, girth growth, and ecosystem restoration indicators.

As a result, monitoring and evaluation of plantation outcomes must account for spatial variability, model-specific indicators, and field-level implementation constraints. Recognizing this complexity, GFD emphasizes evidence-backed evaluation to inform policy corrections and resource optimization—making third-party assessments an essential tool for strategic decision-making.

Scope and Objectives

6. Objective of the Study

- 6.1. Assessment of Plantation Success: To study the survival and growth of plantations raised under different models and in different agro-climatic zones of the state across various age classes.
- 6.2. Identification of Success and Failure: To identify areas of success and failure, and to suggest suitable measures for implementation and replication in cases of success.
- 6.3. To evaluate the reasons for success and failure and to take them to the notice of competent authority for action

7. Scope of Work

The study aims to conduct a third-party evaluation of plantation activities undertaken by the Gujarat Forest Department, covering plantations from 2019–20 to 2024–25, CAMPA plantations from 2014–15 to 2015–16, as per the ToR. It will include:

- Assessment of plantations carried out during the years 2019–20 to 2024–25, including CAMPA plantations from 2014–15 and 2015–16, i.e.,
 - **0–1 Year Plantations (2023–25)**

- **2–5 Year Plantations (2019–23)**
 - **CAMPA Plantations (2014–2025):** 2014–15 to 2015–16, 2021–22 to 2022–23 & 2023–24 to 2024–25.
 - **Mangrove Plantations (2021–25):** 2021–22 to 2022–23 & 2023–24 to 2024–25
- Complete geographical coverage of all circle, divisions/districts, and models implemented under the Forest Department, ensuring no divisions/districts is excluded.

Methodological Framework

8. Research design and approach

The TPME study adopts a structured and evidence-driven methodology to evaluate plantation works undertaken by the Gujarat Forest Department from **2014–15 to 2024–25**, in line with the ToR and **Standing Order No. 8 (Revised 2.0, Amendment 5)**.

Using **stratified random sampling**, **expert validation**, and **drone/GIS mapping**, the study ensures scientific accuracy and operational compliance. The approach is strengthened by:

- **Rolling Reporting:** Real-time field data integration for dynamic tracking.
- **Data Triangulation:** Cross-verification using field records, registers, and geo-tagged/drone imagery.
- **Stakeholder Feedback:** Inputs from forest staff and local beneficiaries to contextualize findings.

This design ensures reliable, timely, and actionable insights for policy and field-level decision-making.

Project Execution Phases

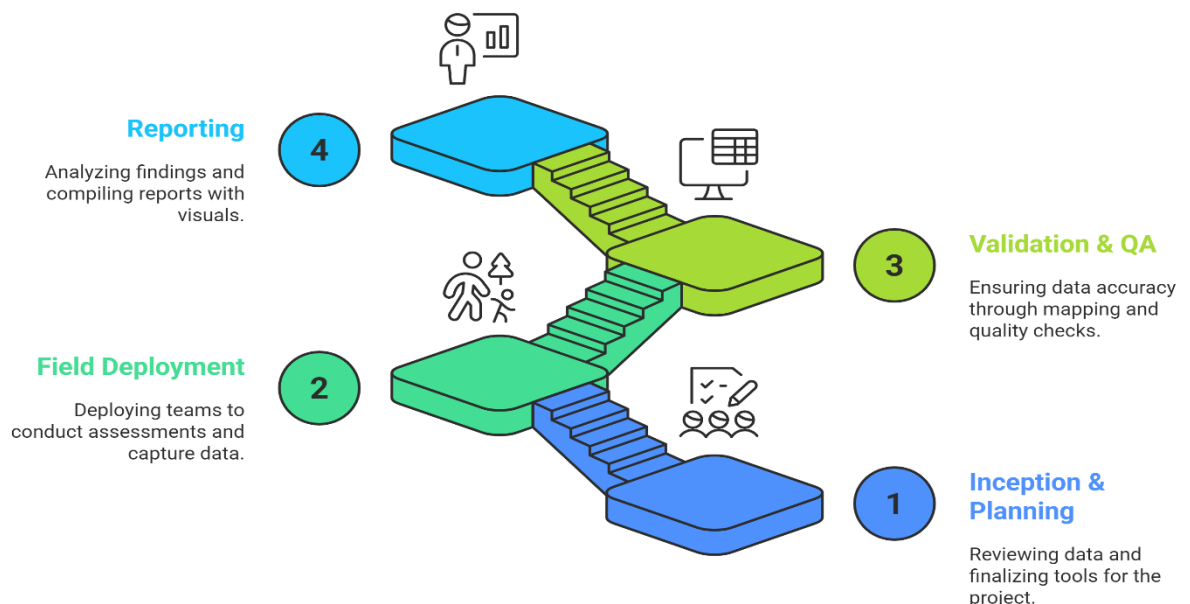


Figure 2 Phased Approach

A. Phase I: Inception & Planning

1. Secondary Research

- Review of APOs, treatment plans, plantation models, and budget utilization
- Cross-checking of historical monitoring records and registers

- Mapping plantation coverage and ecological diversity

2. Sampling Finalization

- Verification and adjustment of sampling plan using actual plantation data
- Mapping selected sample plots using GIS tools
- Division-wise stratification to ensure comprehensive coverage

3. Inception Report

- Finalize team structure, logistics, and monitoring tools
- Submit inception report including pilot plan and sampling framework

Note: Prior to initiating the pilot study and commencing full-scale data collection, **QCI will submit a formal request** to the **Monitoring & Evaluation Wing of the Gujarat Forest Department, at least 15 days in advance**, along with the following details:

- Proposed list of sampled plots
- Names and contact details of the designated field enumerators/assessors

The department will be requested to provide, within 5 working days, the **official Monitoring Sheet and relevant attachments** as prescribed under **Standing Order No. 8 (Revised 2.0)**.

This preparatory step is critical to:

- Ensure alignment** with official data formats and departmental protocols
- Calibrate digital monitoring tools** and pre-fill formats where feasible
- Facilitate smoother coordination** with range-level officials for scheduling, access, and oversight during field operations

This systematic coordination will strengthen procedural consistency, support accurate evaluation practices, and prevent delays during the pilot and full-scale rollout.

B. Phase II: Field Deployment

1. Team Deployment

- 15–20 field teams comprising:
 - Retired Range Forest Officers (RFOs) as third-party validators
 - GIS/technical professionals
 - Enumerators (number adjusted based on plot size and region)

2. Plot-Level Enumeration

- Data collection includes:
 - Sapling survival status
 - Average height
 - Species identification
 - Layout and spacing compliance

Note: Forms will be filled digitally using formats derived from **Annexure-4 (Standing Order 8)** and **Annexure 1(A) of the ToR**.

Each filled form will be verified using:

- Geo-tagged photographs embedded in the form
- Forest officer's ID picture and digital sign-off for traceability

3. Visual Documentation

- Lime (Chuna) powder used to mark plot boundaries for GIS Data
- Minimum five geo-tagged photographs per plot, covering layout, survival status, and species mix
- Drone visuals, where permitted, integrated with GIS datasets for enhanced validation

4. Stakeholder Consultations

- Key Informant Interviews (KIs) with:
 - Range Officers, ACFs, DFOs (if required)
 - Local stakeholders and beneficiaries (e.g., Farm Forestry participants)

C. Phase III: Validation & QA

1. GIS Mapping

- Geo-tagging and digital mapping of each sampled plot
- KML/Shape file creation for integration with forest GIS layers

2. Drone-Based Survey

- 100% of mangrove plots
- 25% of degraded/Gram Van plots
- Manual fallback in restricted areas (e.g., border or wildlife zones)

3. Quality Assurance

- Internal QA protocols and field supervision
- Cross-verification using photographic evidence and forest registers
- Digital sign-off by the RFO and team lead on each plot form

D. Phase IV: Reporting

1. Analysis Framework

- **Quantitative Metrics:** Survival rate, average height, spacing compliance
- **Qualitative Insights:** Implementation issues, species success, stakeholder perspectives
- **Technology Integration:** Drone imagery

2. Report Preparation & Submission

- **Interim Reports** with pilot findings, observations, and supporting visuals
- **Draft Evaluation Report**, incorporating stakeholder feedback
- **Final Consolidated Report** with:
 - Species-wise and model-wise summaries
 - Circle and division-wise grading
 - Geo-tagged Photo annexures, and KML files
 - Separate section for current year (2024–25) plantations

3. Cross-Cutting Features

- **Rolling Reporting Model:** Field data is continuously fed into the reporting system for real-time analysis
- **Triangulation of Data:** Combining field observations, registers, and Geo-tagged & Drone Imagery data for validation
- **Stakeholder Feedback Loop:** Incorporates views from field staff, forest officials, and local beneficiaries to contextualize findings

9. Identification of Stakeholders

To ensure a comprehensive and grounded evaluation of the plantation in Gujarat, QCI has identified the following key stakeholders for structured interactions and consultations:

- Gujarat Forest Department officials (State, District/Divisional, and Range levels)

These stakeholders will be engaged through in-depth interviews, and field-level interactions to gather diverse and meaningful insights across operational, and dimensions of the programme.

Additional stakeholders may be identified and included at later stages, in close consultation with the Gujarat Forest Department, to ensure comprehensive representation and alignment with project objectives.

Sampling

To ensure comprehensive coverage across all regions of Gujarat, the state has been divided into various forest circles and forest divisions for the appropriate distribution of sample size across the state.

However, to initiate the planning process, QCI proposes the following indicative sampling distribution across the Gujarat state.

10. Sampling Strategy

The monitoring and evaluation will be conducted in all circles, districts and divisions in Gujarat including all the models of the plantation works undertaken by the Gujarat Forest Department. A stratified random sampling approach will be adopted, considering the strata as follows:

- **Classification Based on Plantation Age:**

- **0–1 Year Plantations (2023–25):** 5% of total area and plots
- **2–5 Year Plantations (2019–23):** 2% of total area and plots
- **CAMPA Plantations (2014–2025):**
 - 2% of area and plots for plantations from 2014–15 to 2015–16
 - 2% of area and plots for plantations from 2021–22 to 2022–23
 - 5% of area and plots for plantations from 2023–24 to 2024–25
- **Mangrove Plantations (2021–25):**
 - 2% of area and plots for 2021–22 to 2022–23
 - 5% of area and plots for 2023–24 to 2024–25
 - Drone-based monitoring will be prioritized; manual geo-tagged photo monitoring will be used where drone operations are restricted.

- **Plot Selection Criteria**

At least one-third of the total plots in each division will be selected using the following logic:

- 1–3 plots in a range: Select the largest area plot
- 4–6 plots: Select the largest and smallest
- More than 6 plots: Select largest, medium, and smallest plots

This stratified selection approach ensures a representative and diverse sample of plantation works undertaken across different plot sizes.

***Strip Sampling Technique** for selected plantation plots, particularly those having an area of more than 5 hectares.

- Large plantation areas (more than 3 hectares) are difficult to fully enumerate due to logistical constraints. Strip sampling allows focused data collection in a way that still reflects the true status of the entire plot.
- It ensures time-effective monitoring while maintaining representativeness and statistical integrity.

The strategy proposed above is based on the limited availability of the Data; the final selection of sample areas and plots will be undertaken in consultation with the Gujarat Forest Department as per the complete and consolidated data provided by the Department after the award of the contract.

Operational Framework & Execution Plan

To ensure timely, efficient, and high-quality execution of the evaluation, QCI proposes a structured operational framework comprising the following key stages:

11. Preliminary Analysis and Development of Evaluation Framework

QCI will initiate the study through a structured inception phase involving an in-depth review of secondary documents such as Annual Plan of Operations (APOs), plantation treatment plans, species models, and

historical monitoring data. Interactions with field-level officials like DFOs, ACFs, and RFOs will be undertaken to gather practical and operational insights based on their field experience. These inputs, along with the document review, will inform the development of a comprehensive Evaluation Framework outlining performance indicators, data collection methodologies, and plantation-specific assessment parameters, fully aligned with the objectives stated in the ToR and the protocols outlined in Standing Order No. 8 (Revised 2.0, Amendment 5).

12. Preparation of Digital Data Collection Tool

To ensure real-time, accurate, and standardized data capture, QCI will deploy a secure mobile and tablet-based digital platform configured with customized plantation monitoring formats based on the ToR and Standing Order templates. The system will enable geo-tagging, timestamping, video/photo uploads, and synchronized data capture. This platform will streamline data collection and ensure consistency, enabling field teams to digitally record plot-level information and transmit it for backend verification and analysis.

13. Pilot Study

A pilot study will be conducted to validate survey tools, field protocols, and coordination mechanisms before full-scale implementation. QCI will formally request the Gujarat Forest Department to provide monitoring sheets and related attachments ten working days prior to field activities, with a detailed submission made at least fifteen days in advance. This will include the proposed sample plots and names of field enumerators. The pilot study will serve as a critical step in testing team deployment, refining field tools, aligning with departmental protocols, and ensuring effective coordination for the main evaluation phase.

14. Training and Deployment of Assessors

QCI will deploy 15–20 multidisciplinary field teams for the execution of fieldwork. Each team will consist of NABCB-accredited inspection bodies for third-party validation, retired Range Forest Officers serving as domain experts, technical professionals, and trained enumerators. All field personnel will undergo rigorous training sessions focused on the evaluation framework, plantation models, data collection tools, digital form usage, ethical practices, and GIS-based plot identification. The deployment will be staggered geographically to ensure comprehensive coverage and smooth coordination with local forest officials.

15. Plot-Level Assessment and Stakeholder Consultations

The field survey will involve full-plot enumeration or strip sampling, depending on plot size, to collect information on sapling survival rate, average plant height, species identification, and spacing/layout compliance. Geo-tagged photos, and digital sign-offs will be part of the standardized documentation. Drone-based monitoring will be conducted for 100 percent of mangrove plots and 25 percent of degraded and Gram Van plots. Manual photographic documentation will be used where drone operations are not feasible. Stakeholder consultations will include Key Informant Interviews with forest officials and local stakeholders such as Farm Forestry beneficiaries.

16. Data Quality Assurance

A robust quality assurance framework will be implemented through multi-tier validation mechanisms. Real-time monitoring of data will be carried out by QCI professionals at the backend, who will continuously track submissions for consistency and completeness. Cross-verification of collected data with official registers, field observations, and photographic evidence will be conducted. Supervisory visits by senior QCI professionals and NABCB-accredited supervisors will provide additional oversight and ensure procedural compliance during field implementation.

17. Data Analysis and Interpretation

Following field data collection, the data will be systematically analysed using quantitative and qualitative techniques to derive plantation-wise performance. The analysis will include survival rates, average height

distributions, spacing compliance, and species-specific trends. Triangulation of field data with photographic records and forest registers will help ensure analytical depth and accuracy. Qualitative inputs from KIs and FGDs will further contextualize the findings and provide insight into program implementation challenges and local dynamics.

18. Final Reporting

A detailed evaluation report will be prepared capturing findings, success stories, implementation gaps, and strategic recommendations. The report will be presented to the department along with supporting data sets, visual documentation, and annexures for reference.

Project Financials

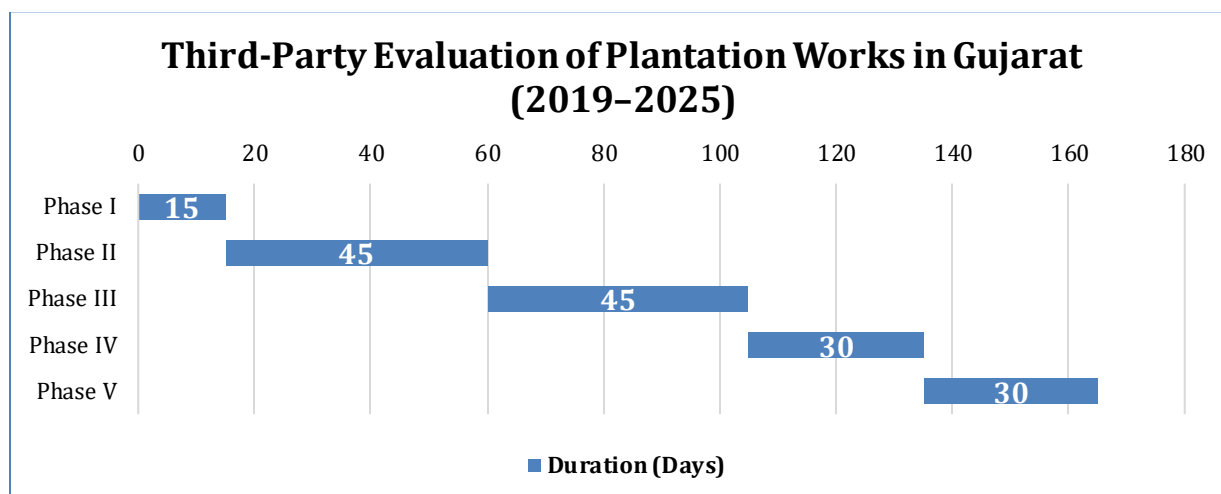
A. Project Implementation *					
Sr. No.	Name of Work	Unit	Unit Cost	Area	Total (INR)
A	Monitoring of Plantations including (Drone Technology)	Hectare	₹ 907.83	12,500	₹ 1,13,47,892
Cost (A)					₹ 1,13,47,892
B	Admin Cost (12%)				₹ 13,61,747
Total (Without Taxes)					₹ 1,27,09,639
C	GST (18%)				₹ 22,87,735.09
Grand Total (With Taxes)					₹ 1,49,97,374

*The Project Implementation Cost includes the following cost:

- Professional fees & Drone Technology fees
- TA/DA and local travel expenses for field teams
- Monitoring & Evaluation activities in line with Standing Order No. 8 (Revised 2.0, Amendment 5) and ToR guidelines
- Report writing, formatting, and printing of final deliverables
- The quoted rates are on a per hectare basis. The total area has been estimated based on initial findings and shall be finalized in consultation with the Gujarat Forest Department (GFD) upon completion of data verification and field mapping. Any change in the total area shall be adjusted on a pro rata basis.
- The scope and financials presented in this proposal exclude nursery evaluation activities as the plantation drive for the current year has already been started. The quoted cost pertains exclusively to the third-party evaluation of forest plantation works.

Brief Work Plan & Key Deliverables

QCI proposes a phased implementation plan spanning approximately 5.5 months (165 days) from the date of award of work, for the successful execution of all key activities. These include conceptualization and development of the evaluation framework, design of schedules/questionnaires, training and deployment of assessors, pilot testing, refinements based on pilot findings, field surveys, data analysis, and final reporting.



The detailed timeline is structured in alignment with the Forest Department's milestones and is outlined above. The timeline is subject to timely cooperation from the Forests and Environment Department, Government of Gujarat, including provision of necessary approvals, data, and feedback at key stages.

Further, in the event of any natural calamity or the deployment of Disaster Management teams in the identified regions, which may affect access or delay field activities, the timeline may need to be revised accordingly. In such cases, QCI will proactively coordinate with the concerned authorities and submit a revised schedule for mutual approval to ensure the quality and integrity of the evaluation are maintained.

Sr. No.	Phase	Milestone / Work Details	Timeline	% Payment
1	Phase I	Completing formalities, deploying manpower, finalizing sites, seeking info, prelim meeting	Within 15 days	5% on receipt and acceptance of Inception Report
2	Phase II	Start field work, complete 50% plots, make interim presentation to department	Within 60 days	45% on receipt and acceptance of Pilot Report
3	Phase III	100% field work, draft report, analysis, submit field formats as per Annexure-I	Within 105 days	20% on completion and acceptance of Phase III - Draft Report
4	Phase IV	Presentation, incorporation of feedback, submit final report + all soft/hard data	Within 135 days	10% on completion and acceptance of Final Report
5	Phase V	Submission of 120 hardbound copies of the final report	Within 165 days	20% on completion and acceptance of Printed Reports

Assistance Required from Gujarat Forest Department (GFD)

To ensure smooth, timely, and effective execution of the Third-Party Evaluation of Plantation Works (2019–2025), the following support is respectfully requested from the Gujarat Forest Department:

1. Provision of Monitoring Sheets and Official Records

- Sharing of plantation-wise monitoring sheets as prescribed under Standing Order No. 8 (Revised 2.0, Amendment 5), including survival rate data, budget utilization, and treatment plans.
- Access to Annual Plan of Operations (APOs) and division-wise plantation registers.

2. Nodal Officer Designation

- Nomination of a state-level and division-level nodal officer(s) for timely coordination, clarifications, and field-level facilitation.

3. Facilitation of Field Access

- Necessary permissions for access to plantation sites across all ranges/divisions, including restricted or border areas.
- Coordination support with RFOs, ACFs, and DFOs for field verification activities and stakeholder consultations.

4. Support for Drone Operations

- Approvals and on-ground facilitation for drone-based monitoring in eligible plantation sites, especially in mangrove and degraded forest plots.

5. Data Verification and Clarifications

- Support in resolving discrepancies between field observations and departmental records, where applicable.
- Verification of GPS/KML data and geo-tagged photographic evidence during the validation phase.

6. Feedback on Draft Report

- Review and inputs on the draft report, especially on plantation model-specific findings and circle/division-wise grading prior to final submission.